

A cheat sheet for why AI isn't bad for the environment

Posted by u/cool_fox • 0 points • 5 comments

Here is OOP:

<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>

So it's well established that antis lie profusely about AI. Here is a quick reference look up to counter anyone arguing in good faith.

#Personal use

[A ChatGPT prompt uses too much energy/water]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/a-chatgpt-prompt-uses-too-much-energywater>)

[Energy](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/energy>)

[Water](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/water>)

[ChatGPT is bad relative to other things we do (it's ten times as bad as a Google search)]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-is-bad-relative-to-other-things-we-do-its-ten-times-as-bad-as-a-google-search>)

[ChatGPT uses enough energy that you should be very careful with how you use it. Don't use it as a search engine or a calculator or just to goof around]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-uses-enough-energy-that-you-should-be-very-careful-with-how-you-use-it-dont-use-it-as-a-search-engine-or-a-calculator-or-just-to-goof-around>)

#Global use

[Data centers are an environmental disaster. This shows that ChatGPT as a whole is using too much energy and we should boycott it]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/data-centers-are-an-environmental-disaster-this-shows-that-chatgpt-as-a-whole-is-using-too-much-energy-and-we-should-boycott-it>)

[ChatGPT may not raise your own carbon footprint much, but it will be very bad for the

environment if everyone starts using it]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-may-not-raise-your-own-carbon-footprint-much-but-it-will-be-very-bad-for-the-environment-if-everyone-starts-using-it>)

[ChatGPT uses as much energy as 20,000 households]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/chatgpt-uses-as-much-energy-as-households>)

[Training an AI model uses too much energy]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/training-an-ai-model-uses-too-much-energy>)

#Other objections

[This is all a gimmick anyway. Why not just use Google? ChatGPT doesn't give better information](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/this-is-all-a-gimmick-anyway-why-not-just-use-google-chatgpt-doesnt-give-better-information>)

[Don't trust some random Substack post over scientific research]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/dont-trust-some-random-substack-post-over-scientific-research>)

##Some other useful intuitions in conversations

[AI companies don't want to give you free energy]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/ai-companies-dont-want-to-give-you-free-energy>)

[It's 3 Wh!!!!](<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/its-wh>)

[We should be focused on systematic change over individual lifestyles]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/i/162196004/we-should-be-focused-on-systematic-change-over-individual-lifestyles>)

OOP also wrote a more in depth explanation from which this cheat sheet is based on, [here] (<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/individual-ai-use-is-not-bad-for>)

Comments

u/Ok_Top9254 • 1 points • 2025-04-30 13:39 UTC

Is the energy calculated with training or image generation? I got way smaller figures. Say 8x80GB H100s are needed to run the whole 4o mini model, that's 8x700W or 5600W. You can serve 240 users in a batch lets say and inference time is a minute. That's $5600W \times 60 / 240 = 1400Ws / 3600$ (convert to Wh) $\Rightarrow 0.39Wh$, or about 3-4 seconds of watching a standard TV, unless I calculated something wrong...

u/cool_fox • 1 points • 2025-04-30 23:37 UTC

I'd have to go dig into the original article to be sure

u/Quick-Window8125 • 13 points • 2025-04-30 04:47 UTC

Next time someone says ChatGPT uses 10x more energy than a Google search, I'm just going to tell them "Yeah... 10 Google searches."

u/SexDefendersUnited • 4 points • 2025-04-30 10:03 UTC

Also, *sometimes it takes 10+ Google searches to find the right piece of info.*

If the AI does the same thing faster and can get more specific instructions, huzzah.

u/cool_fox • 10 points • 2025-04-30 05:06 UTC

I thought my friend cared about the environment BUT OH THE HORROR... They used Google 11 times today